

County Commissioners Meeting, January 5th, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hE40IzV0kgU
Publication Date	2026-01-06T03:39:31Z
Target Category	delaware_county

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Delaware County Commissioners Meeting Report

Meeting Date: January 5, 2026

Meeting Time: 9:00 A.M.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order:** Presiding officer opened the Delaware County Commissioners meeting at 9:00 a.m. on Monday, January 5, 2026, welcoming the family of Corporal Blake Reynolds.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Commissioners Brand, Henry, and Regan.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Commissioner Regan (following reorganization).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Reorganization of the Board:**
 - **President:** Commissioner Regan was nominated, seconded, and elected by roll call vote.
 - **Vice President:** Commissioner Brand was nominated, seconded, and accepted by roll call vote.

- **Employee Recognitions:**
 - **Employee of the Month (January 2026):** Awarded to Don Chambers and the county maintenance team.
 - **Employee of the Year (2025):** Unanimously awarded to Corporal Blake Reynolds. Sheriff Tony Skinner, along with Blake's parents (Bruce and Melissa Reynolds) and in-laws (Mr. and Mrs. David Edelman), accepted the recognition. The board announced plans for a master plaque, a memorial photo in the county building lobby, and working with INDOT/County Engineer Dean Thomas to establish a "memorial mile" on I-69.
- **Board Appointments:**
 - **Annual Appointments (1-year terms):** Approved by roll call vote, including assignments to the Alcohol Tobacco Board, Drainage Board, County Attorney (John Brook and Danielle Snubble; Mr. Murphy resigned), Delaware Advancement Corp., Redevelopment Commission, Community Revitalization Economic Enhancement District (with Rob Keys replacing James Henderson), Council Finance Committee, ECI Solid Waste District, Emergency Communications Board, PTBOA, IT Board, and Emergency Management Advisory Committee.
 - **Statutory/Ordinance Appointments (Specified terms):** Approved by roll call vote, including the Airport Authority, Board of Health, Community Corrections Board, APC, Board of Zoning Appeals, Convention and Tourism Bureau, Fair Board, and Animal Care Services (Austin Hamill replacing Nikki Kirby).

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:16:11 Ordinance 2025-37: Tax Sale Registration Fees**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Danielle / Ed
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board discussed updating and increasing tax sale registration fees (previously proposed at \$25 per calendar year up to \$100 for unlimited sales). Noting comparison data from Marion County (\$1,000 deposit), commissioners expressed concern that current fee levels are inadequate to ensure serious bidders and prevent default issues.
 - **Action & Disposition:** Returned to the table for further research (Passed Unanimously by roll call vote).
- **00:20:10 Ordinance 2025-40: Fixed Asset Capitalization Inventory Policy**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Ed / Danielle
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Updates depreciation budgets and capitalization thresholds for county assets. Minor adjustments to the schedule were submitted via email.
 - **Action & Disposition:** Tabled to the January 20th meeting to allow review of the updated schedule (Passed Unanimously by roll call vote).

- **00:23:23 Commissioners' Detail Addendum for SRI**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Ed / John Brook
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussed the master contract addendum regarding fees (\$100 plus postage per parcel for deed acquisition, plus 15% commission on property sold at the commissioner's deed sale). Legal and board members raised questions regarding phrasing and whether the \$100 fee applies regardless of sale.
 - **Action & Disposition:** Tabled to January 20th; staff instructed to pull the previous contract and invite SRI representatives to clarify fee structures (Passed Unanimously by roll call vote).
- **00:29:20 Amplifying Software Contract**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** John Brook / Board
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussed a three-year software subscription agreement totaling \$64,500 (running through 2028). Legal confirmed that recent state law changes allow software to be paid in advance annually, and council-approved funding is already in place.
 - **Action & Disposition:** Removed from table and **Approved** by roll call vote.
- **00:52:32 County Building Modernization Contract (Phase 1)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board / Ed
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Execution of the official phase-one contract for analyzing the county building to modernize infrastructure.
 - **Action & Disposition:** Approved authorizing Commissioner Regan to sign (Passed Unanimously by roll call vote).
- **00:53:18 Block Mueller Engineering Contract Amendment**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dean Thomas (County Engineer)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** On-call engineering contract extension running from January 1st to June 30th, 2026, utilized on an as-needed basis following Angie's retirement.
 - **Action & Disposition:** **Approved** by roll call vote.
- **00:54:25 Bridge 20 INDOT LPA Coordination Agreement**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dean Thomas / Board
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Coordination agreement with INDOT regarding engineering and project execution for Bridge 20 (located on Walnut Street at the Mississippi River between County Road 1050 North and Eaton Wheeling Pike).
 - **Action & Disposition:** **Approved** authorizing Commissioner Henry to sign via DocuSign (Passed Unanimously by roll call vote).
- **00:54:47 Independent Contractor Agreement for Steve Adams**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board / Legal
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transition contract for IT support following Jim Fluke's retirement (modeled after the Bruce Hackler agreement). Covers Tyler Technologies, public safety agencies, 911 CAD, jail software, and small town police departments (\$85,000, funded within existing contractual services lines).

- **Action & Disposition:** **Approved** by roll call vote.
 - **00:57:19 Microsoft Renewal Agreement**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Ryan Staltz / Board
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Three-year Microsoft enterprise agreement renewal (\$13,740) through reseller Dell. Due to persistent lack of responsiveness since July and potential future cloud/Google migrations, the board opted to delay action.
 - **Action & Disposition:** Tabled (Passed Unanimously by roll call vote).
 - **00:59:04 Resolution 2025-01 / Department Liaisons**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** John Brook / Board
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Maintained current commissioner department liaison assignments and agreed to add the mail room under Commissioner Regan's purview. A formal resolution (2026-01) will be drafted for the next meeting.
 - **Action & Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
 - **01:10:04 IT Room Air Conditioning Unit Replacement**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Don Chambers (Maintenance)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reviewed quotes to replace the undersized mini-split AC unit in the server/IT room. Commissioners discussed incorporating system redundancy (leaving the old unit or adding a transfer switch) and requested apples-to-apples detailed proposals from P1 Mechanical (\$5,515) and Resolve Tech (\$10,980) for the IT committee review.
 - **Action & Disposition:** No final vote taken; referred back to the IT Committee and maintenance for updated proposals.
 - **01:15:35 Jail Roof Leak Repair & Bidding**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Don Chambers / John Brook
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussed extensive leaks at the jail and a preliminary quote exceeding \$150,000 for flat roof replacement. Legal noted that projects over \$150,000 must follow public purchasing and bidding statutes. The board agreed to halt gathering commercial quotes and instead hire an independent roofing assessor (unaffiliated with potential bidding contractors) to evaluate the failed roof<U+2014>which was originally installed two years ago with a warranty<U+2014>before issuing a demand letter and drafting formal specifications for a public bid.
 - **Action & Disposition:** Consensus to pursue an independent engineering/roofing assessment; formal bidding specs to follow.
 - **01:25:04 Payroll Approval**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Auditor's Office
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Consideration of payroll for December 31, 2025, totaling \$1,043,087.44.
 - **Action & Disposition:** **Approved** by roll call vote.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **01:25:44 Rick Yenser** (Newsman and Author)
 - Addressed the board offering New Year gratitudes. Commended the county for directing opioid settlement funds toward community prevention and treatment programs. Discussed heavy local infrastructure and utility reconstruction projects (AT&T fiber optic upgrades and gas line replacements). Expressed ongoing historical concerns regarding the placement and maintenance costs of courts and the jail within a former school building.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff & Board Announcements:**
 - **Road Closures:** Rorton Road closure near County Road 25 West and Walnut Street is delayed until January.
 - **Town Halls:** Q1 in Eaton, Q2 in Cowan, Q3 at Prairie Creek, and Q4 in Daleville.
 - **Lobbyist Contract:** Commissioners noted that state lobbyist Mr. Mitson (Catalyst Group) advised that the upcoming short legislative session will focus primarily on SB 1 corrections and amendments, with little need for paid lobbying services; thus, the contract will not be renewed for this session. Commissioner Brand noted he joined the legislative committees for AIC and ICC.
 - **Postage Update:** Departments with postage lines will allocate 25% of their budget to the central mail machine, managed by Mike Jones, to streamline mailing and curb individual stamp purchases.
 - **Next Meeting:** Tuesday, January 20, 2026.
 - **Adjournment:** The regular meeting recessed/adjourned following a motion and unanimous roll call vote, transitioning into a stormwater meeting.
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